Business Case Template · Expert version

A business case template helps you justify an investment by comparing options, their costs, benefits and risks, and making a clear recommendation backed by numbers.

How to use this template

1. Describe the problem and objectives.
2. List options, always including 'do nothing'.
3. Estimate costs and benefits on the Financials tab; ROI and cumulative net calculate automatically.
4. Assess risks and choose the recommended option.
5. Write the summary and present it to the decision-makers.

Tips

- Be conservative with benefits.
- Show when the investment pays back.
- Use net present value for longer projects.
- Revisit the case at each stage gate.

Business case · Make the recommendation easy to approve

Section	Guidance	Your content
Executive summary	Recommendation and headline numbers.	
Background and problem	What needs to change and why now.	
Objectives	What success looks like.	
Options considered	Including 'do nothing'.	
Recommended option	Why it is best.	
Costs and benefits	See the Financials tab.	
Risks	Key risks and mitigations.	
Timeline	Major milestones.	
Governance	Sponsor and decision-makers.	
Recommendation and decision	What you ask the board to approve.	

Financials · Simple ROI and payback: payback year is when cumulative net turns positive

Item	Year 0	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Total
Costs	120,000	30,000	30,000	30,000	210,000
Benefits	0	90,000	110,000	120,000	320,000
Net benefit	-120,000	60,000	80,000	90,000	110,000
Cumulative net	-120,000	-60,000	20,000	110,000	
ROI (total)					52%